



Build an edtech feature benchmark audit dashboard comparing top learning management and administrative tools across core instructional workflows

- Computer
 - Build an 1EdTech TrustEd Apps compliance gap-analysis matrix covering data privacy, security, accessibility, and generative AI rubrics
- Computer
 - Map out the pricing tiers and margins
 - Build the 1EdTech TrustEd Apps checklist
 - Draft the K-12 go-to-market playbook

Semester can use this as a **complete benchmark, pricing, compliance, and K-12 expansion framework**. The key is to treat K-12 as a configured edition of the same Semester operating system—not as a separate product that fragments the platform.

1. Edtech feature benchmark dashboard

Core workflow benchmark

Use this dashboard internally to compare Semester against major categories of learning-management, student-information, student-success, advising, career, and campus-experience systems.

Core workflow	Traditional LMS	SIS / ERP	Student-success platform	Career platform	Campus app	Semester benchmark
Identity and profile	Course identity	Official student record	Student profile	Career profile	Campus profile	One student-controlled identity across all functions
Academic path	Limited	Official audit / records	Advising notes	Usually absent	Usually absent	Path Snapshot, requirements, scenarios, registration planning

Core workflow	Traditional LMS	SIS / ERP	Student-success platform	Career platform	Campus app	Semester benchmark
Course planning	Limited	Registration catalog	Sometimes limited	Absent	Absent	Compare courses, schedule, constraints, primary and backup plans
Registration readiness	Usually absent	Official registration	Alerts or advising workflow	Absent	Absent	Countdown, holds category, checklist, backups, advisor agenda, official handoff
Course delivery	Strong	Weak	Weak	Weak	Weak	Native workspace plus LMS integration and official deep links
Assignments and deadlines	Strong inside courses	Limited	Limited	Absent	Limited	Unified cross-course Action Center, calendar, study plan, and workload view
Study support	Limited	None	Limited	None	None	Source-linked study plans, practice, guides, flashcards, quizzes, explainers
AI support	Inconsistent	Minimal	Often external	Resume-focused	Minimal	Source-aware, policy-aware, permission-aware Semester Intelligence
Advising	Limited	Record-heavy	Strong	Weak	Weak	Student-controlled plan, agenda, scenario comparison, shared context
Tutoring and support	Links only	None	Referral	None	Service directory	Relevant resource discovery, handoff, follow-up, and Action Center integration

Core workflow	Traditional LMS	SIS / ERP	Student-success platform	Career platform	Campus app	Semester benchmark
Campus life	Minimal	Transactions	Limited	Limited	Stronger	Verified organizations, services, events, communities, opportunities, and action routes
Community	Course discussion	None	Limited	Professional networking	Social/feed model	Purpose-led communities, study groups, mentorship, events, and collaboration rooms
Career readiness	Rare	None	Strong	Strong	Limited	Course-to-skill-to-portfolio-to-opportunity pathway
Portfolio and skills	Limited	Transcript only	Limited	Strong	Limited	Student-controlled Passport with artifacts, verified skills, and visibility controls
Financial milestones	Weak	Official financial records	Limited	None	Some payments	Deadlines, high-level action categories, planning context, and official handoffs
Accessibility preferences	Page-by-page	Varies	Varies	Varies	Varies	Persistent profile-level preferences across the ecosystem
Data provenance	Often opaque	Official but siloed	Varies	Varies	Varies	Source, freshness, confidence, limitation, and official fallback everywhere
Institutional governance	Admin settings	Strong but fragmented	Strong in niche	Strong in niche	Varies	Unified tenant, roles, integrations, content, AI, audit, and feature governance

Core workflow	Traditional LMS	SIS / ERP	Student-success platform	Career platform	Campus app	Semester benchmark
Cross-device experience	Often inconsistent	Often poor	Varies	Good	Good	One synchronized account with responsive, context-aware desktop, mobile, tablet, widget, and offline experiences
Student journey continuity	Course-specific	Record-specific	Intervention-specific	Career-specific	Event-specific	One continuous journey from prospect to alumni

What Semester must outperform

Semester does not need to beat every established vendor at its own narrow specialty on day one. It must outperform them on the **connection between specialties**.

The benchmark promise:

A student should never need to manually connect their academic plan, schedule, coursework, support, campus involvement, portfolio, and career goals. Semester does that connection for them—with sources, controls, permissions, and human support.

Benchmark scoring model

Score every Semester module from 0–5 using these criteria:

Criterion	0	3	5
Real workflow depth	Mockup only	Basic working flow	End-to-end, persistent, exception-safe workflow
Data integrity	Demo-only	Imported data	Authoritative or clearly labeled source, freshness, reconciliation
Privacy and permissions	Generic access	Basic role control	Object-level, consent-based, audited, revocable control
Accessibility	Unverified	Basic keyboard support	WCAG 2.2 AA tested, accessible exports, assistive-tech validation
Mobile readiness	Desktop only	Responsive	Mobile-native workflows, offline support where appropriate
Integration	Manual links	One connection	Standard connector, health, freshness, fallback, reconciliation

Criterion	0	3	5
Observability	No measurement	Basic events	SLOs, error tracking, audit, adoption, support, and quality metrics
Student value	Nice feature	Helpful workflow	Repeatedly reduces real friction and creates visible progress
Institutional value	Local utility	Department value	Governed, measurable, scalable cross-campus value
Defensibility	Easily copied	Some workflows	Unique graph, data relationships, trust, integrations, and adoption loop

A module should not be marketed as “fully built” until it scores at least 4/5 in workflow depth, privacy, accessibility, reliability, and source integrity.

2. TrustEd Apps gap matrix

1EdTech’s TrustEd Apps framework focuses on data privacy, security practices, accessibility, and generative-AI data practices. It helps institutions assess suppliers using a shared structure rather than starting every procurement review from scratch. ^[1835][1683]

Semester gap-analysis matrix

TrustEd Apps domain	Required operating capability	Semester target state	Evidence artifact	Priority
Public policies	Public Privacy Policy and Terms of Service	Current, plain-language, accurate, versioned	Trust Center links and policy changelog	Critical
Data inventory	Know all data collected, purpose, owner, classification, retention	Field-level data map across app, console, integrations, AI, analytics	Data inventory and data-flow diagram	Critical
Data minimization	Collect only necessary data	Minimum-field integrations and opt-in enrichment	Data minimization standard	Critical
Student-data ownership	No sale or misuse of student data	Student Data Promise backed by controls	Public commitment, DPA, technical policy	Critical
Advertising	No behavioral advertising using student records	Sponsored content separated from recommendations and clearly labeled	Advertising and Sponsorship Policy	Critical
Third parties	Disclose subprocessors and data-sharing purpose	Public subprocessor register with review dates	Subprocessor register	Critical
Retention and deletion	Defined retention, export, deletion, and disposal process	Automated retention jobs plus verified deletion workflow	Retention policy and deletion runbook	Critical
Consent and sharing	Student-controlled, purpose-limited, revocable sharing	Advisor, mentor, employer, supporter, community consent controls	Consent model, UX screenshots, audit sample	Critical
Authentication	Secure identity, session, recovery, MFA for sensitive roles	SSO, local auth, admin MFA, fresh auth	Authentication architecture	Critical

TrustEd Apps domain	Required operating capability	Semester target state	Evidence artifact	Priority
Encryption	Encryption in transit and at rest	TLS, encrypted database/storage, encrypted secret management	Security overview	Critical
Authorization	Least privilege and tenant isolation	RBAC, ABAC, object-level controls, RLS, audit logs	Permission matrix and test evidence	Critical
Vulnerability management	Scan, remediate, patch, test	Dependency scanning, secret scanning, security triage	Secure SDLC policy and reports	High
Incident response	Detect, respond, notify, learn	Documented runbooks and tabletop exercises	Incident-response summary	High
Business continuity	Backup, recovery, outage plan	Restore testing, RTO/RPO, status page	Business continuity plan	High
Accessibility	Product accessibility maturity	WCAG 2.2 AA baseline plus accessible exports	Accessibility statement and VPAT	Critical
Accessibility testing	Automated and human testing	Keyboard, screen reader, zoom, mobile, contrast, captions	Accessibility QA record	High
AI transparency	Explain AI use and providers	Provider list, use cases, policy, source controls	AI Policy	Critical
AI data handling	Explain what data AI receives and whether it trains models	Opt-in controls, provider terms, no unauthorized public training	AI data-use matrix	Critical
AI user control	Opt-in/opt-out, delete history, choose sources	AI controls inside Semester	Product screenshots and policy	High
AI quality and safety	Citations, policy enforcement, feedback, human confirmation	Source-grounded outputs and action confirmations	AI evaluation plan	High
Mobile	Accessible mobile use and privacy controls	Mobile-responsive app, notification controls, device-aware access	Mobile accessibility test plan	Medium
Integrations	Documented data sharing and interoperability	Connector contract, scope registry, source/freshness labels	Integration catalog	High
Social interactions	Community safety, moderation, reporting, blocking	Verified groups, reporting, appeals, limits, consent	Community Safety Policy	High
Legal readiness	DPA/DPSA, contract, jurisdiction and subprocessors	Institution-ready agreement package	DPA, DPSA response, contract templates	Critical

TrustEd Apps implementation checklist

Policies and transparency

- ☐ Publish Privacy Policy
- ☐ Publish Terms of Service
- ☐ Publish Acceptable Use Policy
- ☐ Publish Advertising and Sponsorship Policy
- ☐ Publish Student Data Promise
- ☐ Publish AI Policy
- ☐ Publish Accessibility Statement
- ☐ Publish Security Overview
- ☐ Publish Subprocessor Register
- ☐ Publish Data Retention and Deletion Policy
- ☐ Publish Incident Response Summary
- ☐ Publish Support and Escalation Policy
- ☐ Publish Product Status Page

Privacy and data controls

- ☐ Complete data inventory
- ☐ Classify every data field
- ☐ Map every data flow
- ☐ Define retention period for each class
- ☐ Implement export workflow
- ☐ Implement deletion workflow
- ☐ Implement consent grant and revocation workflow
- ☐ Document student, family, advisor, mentor, employer, and staff access boundaries
- ☐ Confirm no sale of student data
- ☐ Confirm no behavioral advertising based on student records

Security and resilience

- ☐ Complete RLS and authorization review
- ☐ Review every SECURITY DEFINER function
- ☐ Add MFA for administrators and high-risk actions
- ☐ Add secrets scanning to CI
- ☐ Add dependency scanning to CI
- ☐ Add audit logging for sensitive actions
- ☐ Run backup restore test
- ☐ Create incident response runbook
- ☐ Perform security tabletop exercise
- ☐ Build public status page
- ☐ Establish vulnerability disclosure process

Accessibility

- ☐ Establish WCAG 2.2 AA acceptance criteria
- ☐ Create VPAT or formal VPAT roadmap
- ☐ Add automated accessibility tests
- ☐ Perform keyboard-only testing
- ☐ Perform screen-reader testing
- ☐ Test zoom and reflow
- ☐ Test contrast and reduced motion
- ☐ Test accessible tables, charts, documents, captions, and exports
- ☐ Establish accessibility issue-reporting channel

Generative AI

- ☐ Document each AI provider and model class
- ☐ Document AI data inputs and outputs

- [] Prevent unauthorized provider training on student data
- [] Implement source selection and permission checks
- [] Implement source citations
- [] Implement course and institution AI policies
- [] Implement student opt-out where appropriate
- [] Implement output deletion/history controls
- [] Require confirmation for send, share, schedule, export, payment, delete, or record
- [] Build prompt-injection protection
- [] Build AI evaluation and incident workflow

The 1EdTech Data Privacy and Security Agreement template is designed to streamline institutional contracts, RFIs, RFPs, and purchasing processes. It should be reviewed with counsel and adapted to Semester’s actual practices rather than copied without legal review. [1284]

3. Pricing tiers and margins

Product pricing structure

Use a hybrid model: self-serve student plans for product-led growth, then institution-sponsored access for scale and verified campus context.

Tier	Buyer	Suggested price	Includes	Target gross-margin profile
Semester Free	Individual student	\$0	Profile, goals, one path/term plan, basic schedule, directory, reminders, limited public tools	High, but acquisition-supported
Semester Plus	Individual student	\$7.99/month or \$59/year	Unlimited plans, scenarios, comparisons, calendar sync, exports, sharing, deeper planning	75–85% after payment, support, and infrastructure
Semester Pro	Individual student	\$14.99/month or \$99/year	Advanced career portfolio, advisor sharing, high-value AI allowance, advanced scenarios, selected premium tools	65–80%, depending on AI usage
Semester Access	Institution-sponsored student	Included in institutional license	SSO, campus data, verified directory, configured features, institution AI policies	70–85% after support and platform costs
Registration Pilot	Institution / department	Fixed pilot fee	25–100 students, onboarding, planning, advisor workflow, outcomes report	45–65% initially; improves with repeatability
Department Edition	Department / college	Annual license	One primary workflow, content configuration, support, basic integration	65–80%
Campus Edition	Institution	Annual enrollment-band license	Multiple modules, SSO, governed content, analytics, implementation	60–75%
Enterprise	Multi-campus / system	Multi-year custom	SCIM, advanced integrations, audit, custom support, managed rollout	50–70% initially; improve toward 70%+

Margin model

Use this formula:

$$\text{Gross Margin} = \frac{\text{Revenue} - \text{Direct Cost of Service}}{\text{Revenue}}$$

Direct cost of service includes:

Cloud and database usage
Storage and media delivery
AI inference and embeddings
Email, SMS, and push notifications
Payment processing
Customer support
Implementation labor
Integration operations
Security tooling
Third-party API costs
Moderation and community safety operations

Margin controls

Cost driver	Risk	Margin protection
AI usage	High variable cost	Per-user allowance, model routing, caching, rate limits, premium usage tiers
Custom integrations	High implementation cost	Connector framework, implementation fee, paid integration tier
Support	Cost rises with complexity	In-product guidance, self-service help, escalation tiers, implementation templates
Storage and media	Unbounded upload cost	Quotas, retention rules, lifecycle management, paid storage allowances
SMS	Expensive at scale	Opt-in, quiet hours, bundle notifications, use push/in-app first
Community moderation	Operational cost	Verified spaces, rate limits, reporting, automated triage plus human escalation
Procurement	Long sales cycle	Trust Room, DPSA/DPA package, security evidence library, standard RFP responses
Institution onboarding	Bespoke labor	Productized launch kit, templates, sandbox, configuration wizard

Pricing rules

- Do not charge students for data export, deletion, or access to their own saved plan.
- Price AI based on real cost, not unlimited promises.
- Charge for high-touch implementation and advanced integrations.
- Use annual institution contracts with implementation, support, and AI usage clearly separated.

- Offer pilot pricing that makes conversion to annual licensing straightforward.
- Make sponsored content, employer access, and marketplace fees separate from academic or support recommendations.

4. K-12 go-to-market playbook

K-12 should be a deliberate extension of the Semester operating system, not a rushed market expansion.

K-12 positioning

Semester for K-12 gives students, families, educators, and districts one connected system for learning, planning, support, student voice, college and career readiness, and school-community engagement.

For K-12, lead with:

- Student organization and learning routines.
- College and career readiness.
- Graduation planning.
- Student support and trusted resource discovery.
- Family-consented milestones.
- Accessibility.
- Safe school-community connection.
- District governance and privacy.

Do not lead with replacing the SIS, gradebook, special education system, or discipline platform.

K-12 market entry segments

Segment	Best initial Semester offer
Middle schools	Student organization, habits, transition planning, interests, career exploration
High schools	Graduation planning, college/career readiness, internships, portfolio, scholarships
Career and technical education	Skills passport, work-based learning, portfolio, employer and mentor connection
Alternative education	Flexible pathway planning, support navigation, credit recovery coordination
Early college / dual enrollment	College-credit planning, transfer pathway, student support, academic readiness
Charter networks	Unified student experience, family communication, career readiness, cross-campus reporting
District student-success teams	Graduation readiness, student support workflows, resource discovery
College and career centers	Portfolio, application tracker, scholarships, mentors, career events

K-12 product configuration

Higher-ed Semester capability	K-12 configuration
My Path	Graduation pathway, credits, graduation requirements, college and career plan
Registration planning	Course requests, pathway selection, elective exploration, dual-enrollment planning
Study Studio	Teacher-approved materials, practice, reading support, study plans, academic-integrity controls
Career Hub	Career exploration, CTE pathways, portfolio, internships, work-based learning
Campus Hub	School activities, clubs, counselors, family resources, events, transportation, meals, support
Community	Verified class, club, cohort, mentor, and project spaces with stricter safety controls
Supporter View	Parent/guardian-consented, age-appropriate milestones; no default access to private student work
Institution Console	District, school, grade, cohort, teacher, counselor, and program configuration
AI	Strict district policy controls, age-aware limitations, approved source packs, human review
Passport	Student portfolio, skills, credentials, reflections, graduation evidence, transition record

K-12 privacy and safety baseline

For K-12, do not accept student PII from a district until you have:

- ☐ District Data Privacy Agreement or DPSA
- ☐ FERPA-aligned school-official and use-limitation terms
- ☐ COPPA assessment for users under 13
- ☐ Parent/guardian consent approach where required
- ☐ Age-aware product design
- ☐ Strict role, school, class, and guardian boundaries
- ☐ No behavioral advertising
- ☐ No sale of student data
- ☐ No public student discovery by default
- ☐ Human moderation and escalation plan
- ☐ Safe messaging restrictions
- ☐ Data retention and deletion schedule
- ☐ District-controlled AI policy
- ☐ Accessibility documentation
- ☐ Incident-response process
- ☐ District security questionnaire package

1EdTech notes that K-12 districts increasingly use privacy and security agreements to simplify procurement and reduce risk, while its privacy rubric addresses issues such as targeted advertising, data access, data handling, security, social interactions, mobile use, and integrations. ^[1834][1835]

K-12 sales motion

Free student and counselor tools
→ School counselor / CTE / college-and-career office adoption
→ Small school pilot
→ District pilot
→ Multi-school rollout
→ District-wide platform agreement
→ State, regional, or partner network expansion

K-12 pilot offer

Semester Graduation, College, and Career Readiness Pilot

Cohort: 50–250 students in grades 9–12.

Duration: One semester or one academic year.

Core capabilities:

- Student profile, interests, goals, and support preferences.
- Graduation and pathway planning.
- Course-selection preparation.
- College, career, scholarship, and CTE exploration.
- Portfolio and skills evidence.
- Counselor meeting agenda.
- Verified resources and events.
- Family-consented milestone sharing.
- Student Action Center.
- District policy-controlled AI support.
- Aggregate, privacy-safe pilot reporting.

Success measures:

- Student plan completion.
- Counselor agenda creation.
- Scholarship and opportunity discovery.
- Portfolio artifacts saved.
- College/career readiness milestones completed.
- Student-reported clarity.
- Counselor-reported usefulness.

- Family engagement where consented.
- Support-resource discovery.

K-12 channels

- District college-and-career readiness offices.
- CTE directors.
- School counselors.
- Early college and dual-enrollment programs.
- Charter-school networks.
- State CTE associations.
- Workforce-development boards.
- Community colleges with dual-enrollment partnerships.
- Scholarship organizations.
- Career exploration and work-based-learning partners.
- Parent and family engagement organizations.

5. Immediate deliverables

Build these next:

1. Feature Benchmark Dashboard

A living internal dashboard using the workflow table above, scored by real production readiness rather than marketing claims.

2. TrustEd Apps Evidence Matrix

One row per rubric requirement with:

```
Requirement
Semester control
Evidence link
Owner
Review date
Gap
Remediation task
Status
```

3. Pricing and Margin Calculator

Model student, department, pilot, institution, and enterprise costs separately. Include AI, implementation, integration, support, storage, notification, moderation, and payment-processing costs.

4. Institutional Trust Room

A secure, versioned repository of all procurement, privacy, security, accessibility, AI, architecture, and contract documents.

5. Semester K–12 Product Requirements Document

Define age-aware identity, guardian consent, safety, moderation, AI restrictions, district configuration, school-level permissions, and data boundaries before building K–12 features.

6. Pilot RFP package

Prepare one for higher education and one for K–12, each with a narrow scope, clear exclusions, measurable outcomes, implementation plan, pricing, and expansion path.

The benchmark standard is simple: Semester should make every student interaction more connected, every institution decision more governable, and every piece of sensitive information more explainable and controllable than the fragmented tools it replaces or connects.



1. <https://www.1edtech.org/resource/dpsa>
2. <https://www.1edtech.org/standards/ai-rubric>
3. <https://www.1edtech.org/standards/security-practices-rubric>
4. <https://www.1edtech.org/program/trustedapps>
5. <https://www.imsglobal.org/spec/security-rubric/v1>
6. <https://www.1edtech.org/standards/accessibility-rubric>
7. <https://www.1edtech.org/standards/data-privacy>
8. <https://www.1edtech.org/blog/prioritize-security-with-1edtechs-data-privacy-and-security-agreement-template>
9. <https://www.1edtech.org/1edtech-article/new-1edtech-rubrics-provide-valuable-insights-for-educators-selecting-trusted>
10. <https://www.1edtech.org/blog/possible-changes-to-coppa-preparing-for-a-new-student-privacy-landscape>
11. https://www.1edtech.org/sites/default/files/media/docs/2024/WBR_Rubrics_010224.pdf
12. <https://assignify.ai/blog/student-data-privacy-k12-compliance-guide>
13. <https://kfixyytsciw.m.pw/iazfwqupgozcjlsxvsjppt>
14. <https://armorstack.ai/ferpa-coppa-student-data/>
15. <https://www.1edtech.org/standards/data-privacy/rubric>